

Week 3.2

Speaking: clarifying misunderstandings
Video study: Fame and fortune

Speaking: clarifying misunderstandings

Work in pairs. Look at the quote. Discuss what you think are the disadvantages of being famous.

‘The image is one thing and the human being is another. It’s very hard to live up to an image, put it that way.’ – Elvis Presley

**Listen to six short conversations about the disadvantages of fame.
Complete the phrases the speakers use to clarify what they mean.**

1. Well, what I _____ was ...
2. What I'm trying to _____ is...
3. Maybe I'm not _____ myself clear.
4. Maybe I should _____ that.
5. _____, that's not what I meant.
6. _____ it that way!



Complete each sentence with an appropriate phrase from the previous exercise. There may be more than one correct answer.

1. I didn't mean that fame had brought Elvis Presley a huge amount of unhappiness. _____ that it didn't bring him the happiness he thought it would.
2. _____. I didn't mean all celebrities have problems. I just meant that a lot of them seem to.
3. I'm not saying the media was responsible for Michael Jackson's difficulties, but I don't think they made his life easy; _____.
4. _____. It's not that actors who cause scandals are less talented. It's just that they become more well known for their scandals than for their acting.



Work in pairs. Discuss your opinions about fame. Rephrase to clarify what you mean where appropriate.

For example:

A: I think it would be really difficult being famous.

B: Really? I think it would be fun!

A: Maybe I should rephrase that. I'm not saying that it wouldn't be fun sometimes. What I meant was that certain things, like going out in public, would be difficult



Video study



Watch the video to 1:10 without any sound, then answer the questions below.

1. What is the man doing?
2. Where do you think he is?
3. Who do you think he is?
4. What do you think he does for a living?



You have people competing for apartments,

Decide if the statements are T (true), F (false) or NM (not mentioned) from the information in the video.

- | | |
|--|------------|
| 1. Jason H Christopher lives in Los Angeles. | T / F / NM |
| 2. He moved from New York three years ago. | T / F / NM |
| 3. He feels that he is struggling to be an actor. | T / F / NM |
| 4. He thinks that acting is the hardest career
in which to achieve success. | T / F / NM |
| 5. He thinks that the harder you try, the less luck
you have in life. | T / F / NM |

Answer the questions.

1. Why does Jason think that it's hard to stay motivated as an actor?
2. How does Jason describe the picture of a 'struggling actor'?
3. Why does he think that LA is such a competitive place to live?
4. Why does he think that acting in LA is like an 'extreme competition inside an extreme competition'?
5. Does he enjoy his job? Why or why not?
6. Does he expect to become more successful in the future? Why or why not?

Complete the sentences with the phrases from the box.

1. You have to be patient because you don't see an _____ for your efforts.
2. Acting is a _____ because it's confusing and it tests you psychologically.
3. I don't like the cliché of _____ 'a struggling actor' because it doesn't reflect reality.
4. The actor has been auditioning for roles, _____, for months, but hasn't been hired yet.
5. You need to _____ if you want to achieve your goals.

full force ~ immediate pay-off ~ mind game ~
quote, unquote ~ stay the course

Write the phrases from the previous exercise next to the correct definitions.

1. instant satisfaction:
2. continue doing something until you achieve what you want:
3. try really hard to do something:
4. an expression used before or after a word or phrase for emphasising that you do not agree with it:
5. a situation that is very confusing:

Work in pairs. Read and follow the instructions.

Imagine you have been asked to film a short video like Jason's about your life and your hopes for the future. Read the questions below and write down your answers.

1. Is the place where you live competitive? Why or why not?
2. How do you feel when you accomplish something?
3. Can see where you are heading in life?
4. Do you feel confident about where your efforts might lead you? Explain your answer.